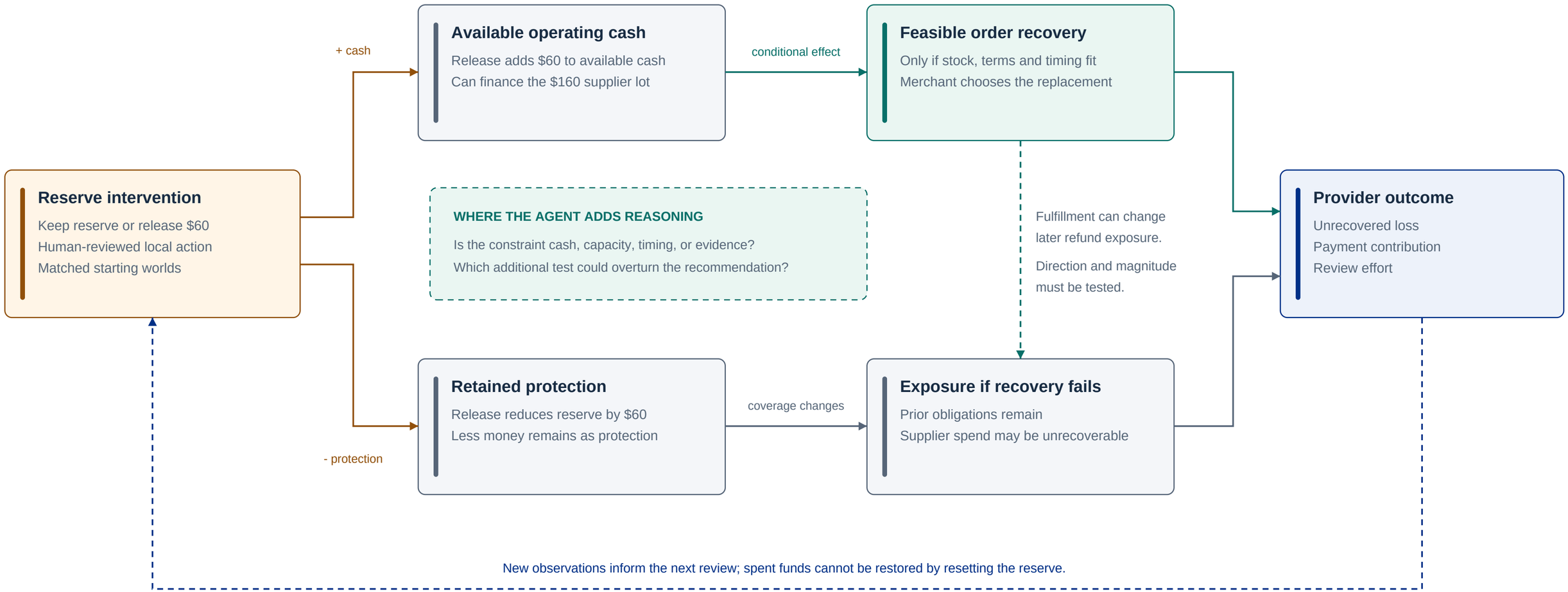
# 3. The hypothesis: reserve policy can change the risk it covers

A causal proposal to test, not an established effect. Agents investigate mechanisms; the evaluator measures outcomes.




Controls: same demand, supply capacity, customer promise and information budget. Track effects on other merchants and unresolved liabilities.

A reserve release is a balance reclassification. Merchant sales are not PayPal revenue; neither metric establishes provider savings.

Research basis: completed Aftershock report, 19 October 2026. Not an official PayPal design.